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08

WEEKS

8-WEEK PROGRAM

The Glute Specialist Program

My signature 4-day program to build stronger, fuller glutes.

Tap to open the interactive program →

Danielle Dawson

8 WEEKS · 4 DAYS/WEEK · 32 WORKOUTS

How to use this book

This book is the companion to your interactive app. The app is the fastest way to train: it logs every set, remembers your weights, runs your rest timer and charts your progress. This PDF gives you the same material in a format you can read, print and fill in.

Tap here to open your interactive program →

The interactive program tracks every set, runs your rest timer, charts your progress and includes every chapter with quizzes. On your phone, tap *Share → Add to Home Screen* so it opens like an app.

This PDF is interactive. Tap any entry in the table of contents to jump to it, use your PDF reader's bookmarks panel to navigate, and fill in the workbook pages at the back directly in Adobe Acrobat, Apple Books/Preview, or most PDF apps. Your entries save with the file.

This program is for educational purposes and is not medical advice. Consult your doctor before starting a new exercise or nutrition plan, especially if you are pregnant, injured or have a medical condition. Stop any exercise that causes pain.

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PART I

The Handbook

14 chapters. Read Chapters 1–4 before you start, and use the rest as a reference.

CHAPTER 1

Welcome & How This Program Works

This is the exact system I use to build my own glutes, and the same structure I give my coaching clients. It isn't a random list of "booty burner" moves. It's a progressive, periodized program, which means every week builds on the last with one goal: to make your glutes measurably stronger and fuller in eight weeks.

What you're getting

- **8 weeks, 4 training days per week, 32 programmed workouts.**
- **Four phases:** Foundation (weeks 1–2), Build (weeks 3–4), Strength (weeks 5–6), Peak (week 7) and a Show-Off/Test week (week 8).
- **Three lower-body days** focused on glutes, plus **one upper-body day** so your shape looks balanced and athletic, not just "glutes on a frame".
- A full **exercise library** with setup, execution, coaching cues, common mistakes and swaps for every movement.
- Built-in **tracking**: log every set's weight and reps, see what you did last time, and watch your strength climb on the progress charts.

The weekly layout

DAY	SESSION	FOCUS	TIME
Monday	Day 1 · Glute Strength	Heavy hip thrusts & RDLs	60–70 min
Tuesday	Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt	Back, shoulders, chest, arms	50–60 min
Wednesday	Rest or walk	8–10k steps	—
Thursday	Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring Pump	Squat pattern, hamstrings, high-tension accessories	55–65 min
Friday	Rest	—	—
Saturday	Day 4 · Lower Burn + Core	Sumo deadlift, unilateral work, core	60–70 min
Sunday	Rest	Meal prep, mobility	—

> **Coach's note:** The days of the week are flexible. The rule is no more than two lower-body days in a row, and at least one rest day between Day 1 and Day 4. A Mon/Tue/Thu/Sat or Sun/Mon/Wed/Fri split works perfectly.

What you need

A commercial gym with a barbell, bench, cables, a hip abduction machine, leg press, Smith machine and dumbbells. Every exercise has swaps in the library if your gym is missing something.

How to read each workout

Every exercise shows **sets × reps**, a **rest time**, and a **target RIR** (reps in reserve, explained in Chapter 4). For example, "4 × 8–10 · 2 min · RIR 2" means four sets of eight to ten reps, two minutes of rest between sets, and each set should end when you could have done about two more good reps.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

What's the minimum rest between Day 1 (Glute Strength) and Day 4 (Lower Burn)?

A. None, you can do them back to back

B. At least one rest day

C. One full week

Answer: B. Both are heavy lower-body sessions. A rest day between them lets your glutes recover so you can train hard again.

CHAPTER 2

Glute Anatomy: Know What You're Building

You can't train a muscle well if you don't know what it does. Your "glutes" are actually three muscles, and each responds to different movements.

Gluteus maximus

The largest muscle in your body and the one that gives your glutes their size and shape. Its main jobs are **hip extension** (driving your thigh back, like the top of a hip thrust), **external rotation** and, for its upper fibers, **abduction** (moving the leg out to the side).

- **Lower glute max** is hit hardest by hip extension under load: hip thrusts, RDLs, deep squats, lunges and back extensions.
- **Upper glute max** ("the shelf") responds to hip extension *plus* abduction: kickbacks angled out, abduction machine leaning forward, and frog pumps.

Gluteus medius & minimus

These sit on the side and top of your hip, under and above the glute max. They **abduct** the hip and stabilize your pelvis every time you stand on one leg. Well-developed glute meds give the upper-side "round" look and protect your knees and lower back. Hit them with the abduction machine, banded walks, cable abduction and single-leg work.

The hamstrings & adductors

These aren't glutes, but they're your glutes' teammates in hip extension. Strong hamstrings make your RDLs and deadlifts stronger, and your adductors (inner thigh) are heavily involved in squats and sumo deadlifts. Training them builds a fuller, more athletic lower body from every angle.

Why exercise variety matters

No single exercise trains every part of the glutes through every range of motion. This program combines:

CATEGORY	EXAMPLE	WHAT IT DOES BEST
Hip thrust pattern	Barbell Hip Thrust	Maximum tension when the glutes are **shortened** (top of the movement)
Hinge pattern	RDL, 45° Back Extension	High tension when the glutes are **stretched**
Squat & lunge pattern	Bulgarian Split Squat, Smith Squat	Deep hip flexion under load, plus the quads
Abduction	Abduction machine, cable kickback	Glute med/min and upper glute max

The research: Growing evidence suggests that training muscles at long muscle lengths (the stretched position) is especially effective for growth. That's why deep split squats, RDLs and lunges are non-negotiable in this program, even though hip thrusts get all the hype.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Which exercise type puts the most tension on the glutes in a STRETCHED position?

A. Hip thrust

B. Romanian deadlift

C. Frog pumps

Answer: B. The bottom of an RDL places the glutes and hamstrings under load at long muscle lengths. Hip thrusts and frog pumps are hardest at the top, when the glutes are shortened.

CHAPTER 3

The Science of Muscle Growth

Here's how muscle actually grows, so you understand why every set in this program matters.

1. Mechanical tension is the main driver

Muscle grows when its fibers produce high force under load. The reps that count most are the hard ones near the end of a set, when your muscle fibers are fully recruited and moving slowly against heavy resistance. This is why **effort** matters more than "feeling the burn".

2. Volume: how much you do each week

Volume is the number of hard sets per muscle per week. Research consistently shows that about **10–20 hard sets per muscle per week** is a productive range for most people. This program starts at the lower end and builds up:

PHASE	APPROX. DIRECT GLUTE SETS PER WEEK
Foundation (wk 1–2)	~14–16
Build (wk 3–4)	~18–20
Strength (wk 5–6)	~18–20, heavier
Peak (wk 7)	~18, heaviest
Show-Off (wk 8)	~14, test & recover

3. Frequency: train it 2–3× per week

Training a muscle at least twice per week tends to beat once a week when weekly volume is equal. That's why your glutes are trained on three separate days.

4. Proximity to failure

A set only stimulates growth if it's hard enough. Most of your sets should end with **0–3 reps in reserve**. Sets that stop 5+ reps from failure don't do much for growth.

5. Rep ranges: heavy isn't the only way

Muscle grows across a wide range of reps, roughly 5 to 30 per set, *as long as the set is taken close to failure*. Heavy sets (5–8) build strength and are time-efficient. Moderate sets (8–15) are the sweet spot for growth. High-rep sets (15–30) are great for isolation moves where heavy loads aren't practical. You'll use all three.

6. Recovery is when growth happens

Training is the stimulus. Growth happens while you recover, which depends on sleep, protein and total calories. Chapters 9 and 10 cover these.

> **Coach's note:** "I want to tone, not grow" is a myth. "Toned" simply means having enough muscle and low enough body fat to see its shape. Building muscle *is* toning.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

What's the main driver of muscle growth?

A. Getting as sweaty as possible

B. Mechanical tension from hard sets

C. Doing a different workout every day

Answer: B. Muscles grow in response to high tension, especially in the last few hard reps of a set. Sweat and constant variety don't build muscle.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Roughly how many hard sets per muscle per week is productive for most people?

A. 2–4

B. 10–20

C. 40+

Answer: B. Most research points to about 10–20 weekly hard sets per muscle as a productive range. More isn't always better, because you also have to recover.

CHAPTER 4

Effort: The RIR Scale

RIR means **Reps In Reserve**: how many more good-form reps you could have done when you stopped the set. It's the most useful tool for making sure every set is hard enough without wrecking you.

RIR	WHAT IT FEELS LIKE	WHEN YOU'LL USE IT
4+	Easy. Could do many more	Warm-up sets only
3	Challenging, bar speed still fast	Foundation phase, learning a move
2	Hard, reps start slowing	Most working sets
1	Very hard, one rep left	Strength & Peak phases
0	True failure. Couldn't do another rep	Last set of isolation moves only

How to get better at judging RIR

Most beginners underestimate how many reps they have left. Do this once in your first two weeks: on the **last set** of a safe machine exercise (leg press, abduction or hamstring curl), predict your RIR, then keep going until you truly can't. If you predicted 2 but did 6 more, you need to push harder on your working sets.

> **Safety rule:** Never take barbell hip thrusts, RDLs, sumo deadlifts or squats to true failure (RIR 0). Use RIR 1–2 on these. Save failure for machines and isolation exercises where failing is safe.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

You finish a set of leg press and could have done about 2 more good reps. What's your RIR?

A. 0

B. 2

C. 10

Answer: B. Reps In Reserve is the number of quality reps left in the tank. Two more possible reps = RIR 2.

CHAPTER 5

Progressive Overload: The Only Rule That Matters

If you do the same weights for the same reps every week, your body has no reason to change. **Progressive overload** means gradually asking your muscles to do more over time.

The double progression method

This is the system you'll use for every exercise:

1. Each exercise has a **rep range**, e.g. 8–10.
2. Pick a weight you can do for the **bottom** of the range at the target RIR.
3. Each session, try to add reps with the same weight.
4. When you hit the **top** of the range on all sets, increase the weight next session (usually 5–10 lb for lower-body barbell lifts, 2.5–5 lb for dumbbells and isolation work).
5. The reps drop back to the bottom of the range and you build up again.

A real example: Barbell Hip Thrust, 3 × 8–10

SESSION	WEIGHT	SET 1	SET 2	SET 3	ACTION
1	135 lb	8	8	8	Keep weight, add reps
2	135 lb	10	9	8	Keep weight
3	135 lb	10	10	10	✅ Top of range. Add weight
4	145 lb	8	8	7	Keep building

> **The app does this for you:** In every workout, you'll see what you lifted last time next to each exercise. Your only job is to beat it, by one rep or a few pounds.

Other ways to progress

When you can't add weight or reps, you can still progress by improving **range of motion** (deeper split squats), **control** (a slower 3-second lowering), **pauses** at the hardest point, or **less momentum**. Better reps are progress too.

When progress stalls

Everyone stalls eventually. If an exercise hasn't improved for **3 sessions in a row**:

1. Check your sleep, protein and calories first. These cause 80% of stalls.
2. Make sure you're actually reaching the target RIR.
3. Drop the weight by 10%, build back up with perfect form, and you'll usually pass your old best within two to three weeks.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Your target is 3 × 10–12 and you hit 12, 12, 12 this session. What do you do next time?

A. Keep the same weight forever

B. Increase the weight and aim for 10+ reps

C. Drop to 1 set

Answer: B. You hit the top of the range on all sets, so it's time to add weight. Your reps will drop back toward 10 and you build up again. That's double progression.

CHAPTER 6

Choosing Your Starting Weights

Week 1 is your **calibration week**. Don't guess, and don't let your ego pick the weights.

The calibration process

1. Start each exercise with a weight you're confident you can lift for the target reps.
2. Do your first working set and rate the RIR honestly.
3. Adjust for the next set using the table below.
4. Log the weight that landed you closest to the target RIR. That's your starting point.

FIRST SET FELT LIKE...	ADJUST THE NEXT SET BY
RIR 5+ (way too easy)	+15–20%
RIR 4	+10%
RIR 2–3 (on target)	Keep it
RIR 0–1 (too hard)	−10%
Form broke down	−15–20% and fix technique

Suggested starting points for beginners

These are rough guides. Your calibration sets matter more.

EXERCISE	BRAND-NEW LIFTER	SOME EXPERIENCE
Barbell Hip Thrust	Empty bar (45 lb)	95–135 lb
Romanian Deadlift	2 × 15 lb DBs	Bar + 10s (65 lb)
Bulgarian Split Squat	Bodyweight	2 × 15–20 lb DBs
DB Chest Press	2 × 10–15 lb	2 × 20–30 lb
Lat Pulldown	40–50 lb	70–90 lb

> **Coach's note:** Starting light is not weakness. It's the reason you'll still be progressing in week 8 while the girl who started too heavy is stuck or hurt.

CHAPTER 7

Warming Up the Right Way

A good warm-up takes 8–10 minutes and makes your first working set stronger and safer.

Part 1: General warm-up (5 min)

Incline walk or bike at an easy pace until you're warm and breathing a little harder.

Part 2: Activation (2–3 min)

- Glute bridges × 15 with a 2-sec squeeze
- Banded lateral walks × 10 steps each way
- Bodyweight RDL (hip hinge) × 10

The goal isn't to fatigue the glutes. It's to "wake up" the mind-muscle connection.

Part 3: Ramp-up sets for your first big lift

Before your first heavy exercise each day, do 2–4 lighter sets. Use the **Warm-Up Calculator** in the Tools tab to get exact weights.

RAMP SET	% OF WORKING WEIGHT	REPS
1	Empty bar or ~40%	10
2	~60%	6
3	~80%	3
4 (heavy days only)	~90%	1

You only need ramp-up sets for your **first** exercise of each movement pattern. By the time you get to your accessories, you're warm.

CHAPTER 8

Rest, Tempo & the Mind-Muscle Connection

Rest periods

Rest is part of the set. Cutting rest short to "keep your heart rate up" means lifting less weight and getting less tension, which means less growth.

EXERCISE TYPE	REST
Heavy compound (hip thrust, RDL, squat, sumo DL)	2–3 minutes
Unilateral & machine compounds	90 sec – 2 min
Isolation (kickbacks, abduction, curls)	60–90 sec

The app's **rest timer starts automatically** when you tap off a set.

Tempo

Control the lowering phase (about 2–3 seconds) on every rep, pause briefly where the exercise is hardest, then lift with intent. Don't bounce out of the bottom of RDLs and split squats.

Mind-muscle connection

Studies show that focusing on the target muscle can increase its activation, especially on isolation exercises with lighter loads. On kickbacks, abduction and frog pumps, think about the glute doing the work. On heavy compounds, focus on good technique and pushing hard. The glutes will work.

CHAPTER 9

Recovery, Soreness & Deloads

Sleep

Sleep is the most underrated growth tool. Aim for **7–9 hours**. Short sleep reduces strength, increases hunger and impairs muscle recovery. If you only fix one thing outside the gym, fix this.

Daily steps

Aim for **7,000–10,000 steps** on most days. Walking supports recovery, heart health and fat loss without interfering with your lifting.

Soreness (DOMS)

Soreness 24–72 hours after training is normal, especially in Weeks 1 and 3 when the program changes. **Soreness is not a measure of a good workout.** You can grow without being sore. If you're so sore you can't train with good form, do a lighter session at the planned volume, go for a walk and prioritize sleep.

Pain vs. effort

NORMAL TRAINING DISCOMFORT	STOP AND REASSESS
Burning in the working muscle	Sharp, stabbing or pinching pain
Dull soreness the next day	Pain in a joint (knee, hip, lower back)
General fatigue	Pain that gets worse with each rep
	Numbness or tingling

If something hurts, swap the exercise for an alternative from the library. If pain persists for more than a few days, see a physical therapist or doctor.

Week 8 and deloads

Week 8 reduces your total volume while you test your strength. This works as a partial deload. After you finish the program, take **one easy week** (same exercises, half the sets, RIR 3–4) before starting your next block.

CHAPTER 10

Nutrition for Glute Growth

You can't build muscle out of thin air. Training is the signal, and food provides the building materials.

Step 1: Choose your phase

YOUR GOAL	CALORIES	EXPECTED CHANGE
Build (grow glutes, accept a little fat)	Maintenance + 100–300 kcal	Weight up ~0.25–0.5 lb/week
Recomp (newer lifters with some fat to lose)	Around maintenance	Weight stable, shape improves
Lean out	Maintenance – 300–500 kcal	Weight down 0.5–1% of body weight/week

> **Coach's note:** If you're newer to lifting, a recomp at maintenance is usually the sweet spot. You can build muscle and lose some fat at the same time. If you've lifted for 2+ years, a small surplus will grow your glutes faster.

Step 2: Hit your protein

Aim for **0.7–1.0 g of protein per pound of goal body weight** daily (about 1.6–2.2 g/kg). Spread it over 3–5 meals with at least 25–40 g each.

Step 3: Eat carbs around training

Carbs fuel hard training. Have a carb + protein meal 1–3 hours before you lift (e.g. rice + chicken, oats + protein, a bagel with eggs) and another within a few hours after.

Supplements that actually work

SUPPLEMENT	EVIDENCE	HOW TO USE
Creatine monohydrate	Strong. Improves strength and muscle gain	3–5 g daily, any time. May add 1–3 lb of water weight (inside the muscle, which is a good thing)
Protein powder	Strong (it's just food)	Use to reach your daily protein
Caffeine	Strong for performance	1–3 mg/kg 30–60 min before training
Vitamin D	Useful if deficient	Ask your doctor to test
"Booty pills", fat burners	None	Skip them and save your money

For the full system, including macro calculations, meal plans and grocery lists, see my **Fuel Like A Baddie** guide.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

How much protein per day is a good target for building muscle?

A. 20 g total

B. 0.7–1.0 g per lb of goal body weight

C. As little as possible

Answer: B. About 0.7–1.0 g per pound (1.6–2.2 g/kg) of goal body weight supports muscle growth for most women who train.

CHAPTER 11

Tracking Your Progress

The mirror changes slowly, and the scale fluctuates for reasons that have nothing to do with fat or muscle. Track these three things instead:

1. Strength (the most important)

If your hip thrust, RDL and split squat numbers are going up while your nutrition is consistent, your glutes are growing. Use the **Progress** tab to see your charts.

2. Photos

- Take them every 2 weeks, in the same place, same lighting, same time of day (morning, before eating).
- Front, side and back. Relaxed, then flexed.
- Same outfit every time.
- Compare Week 0 to Week 8, not Tuesday to Wednesday.

3. Measurements

Measure the widest part of your glutes, your hips, your waist at the navel and the top of your thigh every 2 weeks. Log them in the Progress tab. A growing glute measurement with a stable or shrinking waist is the goal.

Why the scale lies

Your weight can swing 2–5 lb day to day from water, salt, carbs, digestion, your menstrual cycle and soreness (sore muscles hold water). Look at the **weekly average**, not individual days.

CHAPTER 12

Troubleshooting: Fix It Fast

"I feel hip thrusts in my quads." Your feet are too close to your body. Move them forward until your shins are vertical at the top. Also make sure you're driving through your heels.

"I feel hip thrusts in my lower back." You're arching at the top instead of finishing with your glutes. Tuck your chin, keep your ribs down and tilt your pelvis under at the top. Reduce the weight if needed.

"I feel RDLs in my lower back, not my hamstrings." You're probably rounding or lowering too far. Stop at the point where your hamstrings are fully stretched. That might be just below the knee, and that's fine. Push your hips back further, not down.

"The hip thrust bar hurts my hips." Use a thick bar pad, or fold a yoga mat under the pad. A Smith machine or hip thrust machine works too.

"My knee hurts in Bulgarian split squats." Move your front foot further forward, lean your torso slightly, and make sure your knee tracks over your toes. If pain persists, swap to reverse lunges or step-ups.

"I don't feel my glutes in kickbacks." Lower the weight, slow down and stop the movement before your back arches. Kick back and slightly out.

"I missed a workout." Don't skip it. Do it next and push the schedule back a day. If you miss a whole week, repeat the previous week.

"The gym is packed and I can't get the equipment." Use the swaps in the exercise library. Same movement pattern, same rep range, same effort.

CHAPTER 13

After the 8 Weeks

You finished. Here's what to do next:

1. **Test day (Week 8):** Record your best hip thrust, RDL and sumo deadlift on the PR Wall. Retake your photos and measurements.
2. **Take an easy week:** same exercises, half the sets, light weights.
3. **Run it again, heavier:** Start Week 1 using your *current* working weights. Most of my clients run this program 2–3 times in a row with great results.
4. **Or level up:** Add my Press Like A Boss program for a full upper/lower split, or apply for 1:1 coaching to get a fully custom plan.

CHAPTER 14

Frequently Asked Questions

Can I do cardio on this program? Yes. Walking and incline walking are ideal. Keep hard cardio (sprints, HIIT, spin classes) to 1–2 sessions a week, and not right before leg days.

Can I add an extra glute day? Not in your first run. More isn't better if you can't recover from it. Push harder on the four days you have.

Will this work at home? The program is designed for a gym. With a barbell, bench, bands and adjustable dumbbells, you can use the swaps in the library for most exercises.

I'm on my period and feel weak. What do I do? Train anyway if you feel up to it, but use RIR 3 and don't chase PRs. Strength usually comes back within a few days.

Is it normal to gain weight at the start? Yes. New training increases water and glycogen stored in muscle. A 1–3 lb bump in the first two weeks is normal and is not fat.

How long until I see results? Most women notice strength gains within 2–3 weeks, feel a difference in how their jeans fit by week 4–6, and see a clear change in photos by week 8. Real transformations come from repeating good blocks for 6–12 months.

PART II

The Program

Every workout, week by week. Log your sets in the app or in the fillable workbook at the back of this book.

Week 1

FOUNDATION PHASE

Calibration week. Learn each movement and find your working weights (Chapter 6).

Day 1 · Glute Strength

Heavy hip extension: the foundation of glute size.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Barbell Hip Thrust	3 × 10–12	3	2 min
Romanian Deadlift	3 × 10–12	3	2 min
Bulgarian Split Squat	3 × 12–15 /side	3	75s
Cable Kickback	3 × 12–15 /side	3	75s
Hip Abduction Machine	2 × 15–20	2	60s

Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt

Back, shoulders and arms for a balanced, athletic shape.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
DB Chest Press	3 × 10–12	3	2 min
Lat Pulldown	3 × 10–12	3	2 min
Seated Cable Row	3 × 12–15	3	75s
DB Shoulder Press	3 × 12–15	3	75s
Lateral Raise	3 × 12–15	3	75s
Tricep Rope Pushdown	2 × 15–20	2	60s

Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring

Stretch-focused work for the glutes and hamstrings.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Smith Machine Squat	3 × 10–12	3	2 min
Lying Hamstring Curl	3 × 12–15	3	75s
Walking Lunges	3 × 12–15 /side	3	75s
45° Back Extension	3 × 12–15	3	75s
Frog Pumps	2 × 15–20	2	60s

Day 4 · Lower Body + Core

Heavy pulls, single-leg strength and core.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Sumo Deadlift	3 × 10–12	3	2 min
Step-Ups	3 × 12–15 /side	3	75s
Single-Leg Hip Thrust	3 × 12–15 /side	3	75s
Leg Press	3 × 12–15	3	75s
Weighted Plank	2 × 15–20	2	60s
Hanging Knee Raise	2 × 15–20	2	60s

Week 2

FOUNDATION PHASE

Same structure. Beat Week 1 by a rep or a few pounds on every exercise.

Day 1 · Glute Strength

Heavy hip extension: the foundation of glute size.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Barbell Hip Thrust	3 × 10–12	2	2 min
Romanian Deadlift	3 × 10–12	2	2 min
Bulgarian Split Squat	3 × 12–15 /side	2	75s
Cable Kickback	3 × 12–15 /side	2	75s
Hip Abduction Machine	2 × 15–20	1	60s

Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt

Back, shoulders and arms for a balanced, athletic shape.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
DB Chest Press	3 × 10–12	2	2 min
Lat Pulldown	3 × 10–12	2	2 min
Seated Cable Row	3 × 12–15	2	75s
DB Shoulder Press	3 × 12–15	2	75s
Lateral Raise	3 × 12–15	2	75s
Tricep Rope Pushdown	2 × 15–20	1	60s

Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring

Stretch-focused work for the glutes and hamstrings.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Smith Machine Squat	3 × 10–12	2	2 min
Lying Hamstring Curl	3 × 12–15	2	75s
Walking Lunges	3 × 12–15 /side	2	75s
45° Back Extension	3 × 12–15	2	75s
Frog Pumps	2 × 15–20	1	60s

Day 4 · Lower Body + Core

Heavy pulls, single-leg strength and core.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Sumo Deadlift	3 × 10–12	2	2 min
Step-Ups	3 × 12–15 /side	2	75s
Single-Leg Hip Thrust	3 × 12–15 /side	2	75s
Leg Press	3 × 12–15	2	75s
Weighted Plank	2 × 15–20	1	60s
Hanging Knee Raise	2 × 15–20	1	60s

Week 3

BUILD PHASE

Volume increases: an extra set on your main lifts. Expect some soreness this week.

Day 1 · Glute Strength

Heavy hip extension: the foundation of glute size.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Barbell Hip Thrust	4 × 8–10	2	2 min
Romanian Deadlift	4 × 8–10	2	2 min
Bulgarian Split Squat	3 × 10–12 /side	2	75s
Cable Kickback	3 × 10–12 /side	2	75s
Hip Abduction Machine	3 × 15–20	1	60s

Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt

Back, shoulders and arms for a balanced, athletic shape.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
DB Chest Press	4 × 8–10	2	2 min
Lat Pulldown	4 × 8–10	2	2 min
Seated Cable Row	3 × 10–12	2	75s
DB Shoulder Press	3 × 10–12	2	75s
Lateral Raise	3 × 10–12	2	75s
Tricep Rope Pushdown	3 × 15–20	1	60s

Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring

Stretch-focused work for the glutes and hamstrings.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Smith Machine Squat	4 × 8–10	2	2 min
Lying Hamstring Curl	3 × 10–12	2	75s
Walking Lunges	3 × 10–12 /side	2	75s
45° Back Extension	3 × 10–12	2	75s
Frog Pumps	3 × 15–20	1	60s

Day 4 · Lower Body + Core

Heavy pulls, single-leg strength and core.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Sumo Deadlift	4 × 8–10	2	2 min
Step-Ups	3 × 10–12 /side	2	75s
Single-Leg Hip Thrust	3 × 10–12 /side	2	75s
Leg Press	3 × 10–12	2	75s
Weighted Plank	3 × 15–20	1	60s
Hanging Knee Raise	3 × 15–20	1	60s

Week 4

BUILD PHASE

Double progression: add weight on any exercise where you hit the top of the range last week.

Day 1 · Glute Strength

Heavy hip extension: the foundation of glute size.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Barbell Hip Thrust	4 × 8–10	1–2	2 min
Romanian Deadlift	4 × 8–10	1–2	2 min
Bulgarian Split Squat	3 × 10–12 /side	1–2	75s
Cable Kickback	3 × 10–12 /side	1–2	75s
Hip Abduction Machine	3 × 15–20	0–1	60s

Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt

Back, shoulders and arms for a balanced, athletic shape.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
DB Chest Press	4 × 8–10	1–2	2 min
Lat Pulldown	4 × 8–10	1–2	2 min
Seated Cable Row	3 × 10–12	1–2	75s
DB Shoulder Press	3 × 10–12	1–2	75s
Lateral Raise	3 × 10–12	1–2	75s
Tricep Rope Pushdown	3 × 15–20	0–1	60s

Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring

Stretch-focused work for the glutes and hamstrings.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Smith Machine Squat	4 × 8–10	1–2	2 min
Lying Hamstring Curl	3 × 10–12	1–2	75s
Walking Lunges	3 × 10–12 /side	1–2	75s
45° Back Extension	3 × 10–12	1–2	75s
Frog Pumps	3 × 15–20	0–1	60s

Day 4 · Lower Body + Core

Heavy pulls, single-leg strength and core.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Sumo Deadlift	4 × 8–10	1–2	2 min
Step-Ups	3 × 10–12 /side	1–2	75s
Single-Leg Hip Thrust	3 × 10–12 /side	1–2	75s
Leg Press	3 × 10–12	1–2	75s
Weighted Plank	3 × 15–20	0–1	60s
Hanging Knee Raise	3 × 15–20	0–1	60s

Week 5

STRENGTH PHASE

Heavier loads, lower reps, longer rest. Focus on bar speed and technique.

Day 1 · Glute Strength

Heavy hip extension: the foundation of glute size.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Barbell Hip Thrust	4 × 6–8	2	2.5 min
Romanian Deadlift	4 × 6–8	2	2.5 min
Bulgarian Split Squat	3 × 8–12 /side	2	90s
Cable Kickback	3 × 8–12 /side	2	90s
Hip Abduction Machine	3 × 12–15	1	60s

Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt

Back, shoulders and arms for a balanced, athletic shape.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
DB Chest Press	4 × 6–8	2	2.5 min
Lat Pulldown	4 × 6–8	2	2.5 min
Seated Cable Row	3 × 8–12	2	90s
DB Shoulder Press	3 × 8–12	2	90s
Lateral Raise	3 × 8–12	2	90s
Tricep Rope Pushdown	3 × 12–15	1	60s

Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring

Stretch-focused work for the glutes and hamstrings.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Smith Machine Squat	4 × 6–8	2	2.5 min
Lying Hamstring Curl	3 × 8–12	2	90s
Walking Lunges	3 × 8–12 /side	2	90s
45° Back Extension	3 × 8–12	2	90s
Frog Pumps	3 × 12–15	1	60s

Day 4 · Lower Body + Core

Heavy pulls, single-leg strength and core.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Sumo Deadlift	4 × 6–8	2	2.5 min
Step-Ups	3 × 8–12 /side	2	90s
Single-Leg Hip Thrust	3 × 8–12 /side	2	90s
Leg Press	3 × 8–12	2	90s
Weighted Plank	3 × 12–15	1	60s
Hanging Knee Raise	3 × 12–15	1	60s

Week 6

STRENGTH PHASE

Push your main lifts. Film one set of hip thrusts and compare with the library cues.

Day 1 · Glute Strength

Heavy hip extension: the foundation of glute size.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Barbell Hip Thrust	4 × 6–8	1–2	2.5 min
Romanian Deadlift	4 × 6–8	1–2	2.5 min
Bulgarian Split Squat	3 × 8–12 /side	1–2	90s
Cable Kickback	3 × 8–12 /side	1–2	90s
Hip Abduction Machine	3 × 12–15	0–1	60s

Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt

Back, shoulders and arms for a balanced, athletic shape.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
DB Chest Press	4 × 6–8	1–2	2.5 min
Lat Pulldown	4 × 6–8	1–2	2.5 min
Seated Cable Row	3 × 8–12	1–2	90s
DB Shoulder Press	3 × 8–12	1–2	90s
Lateral Raise	3 × 8–12	1–2	90s
Tricep Rope Pushdown	3 × 12–15	0–1	60s

Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring

Stretch-focused work for the glutes and hamstrings.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Smith Machine Squat	4 × 6–8	1–2	2.5 min
Lying Hamstring Curl	3 × 8–12	1–2	90s
Walking Lunges	3 × 8–12 /side	1–2	90s
45° Back Extension	3 × 8–12	1–2	90s
Frog Pumps	3 × 12–15	0–1	60s

Day 4 · Lower Body + Core

Heavy pulls, single-leg strength and core.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Sumo Deadlift	4 × 6–8	1–2	2.5 min
Step-Ups	3 × 8–12 /side	1–2	90s
Single-Leg Hip Thrust	3 × 8–12 /side	1–2	90s
Leg Press	3 × 8–12	1–2	90s
Weighted Plank	3 × 12–15	0–1	60s
Hanging Knee Raise	3 × 12–15	0–1	60s

Week 7

PEAK PHASE

Heaviest week of the program. Full rest periods. Bring a spotter for heavy sets.

Day 1 · Glute Strength

Heavy hip extension: the foundation of glute size.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Barbell Hip Thrust	5 × 5	1–2	3 min
Romanian Deadlift	5 × 5	1–2	3 min
Bulgarian Split Squat	3 × 8–10 /side	1	90s
Cable Kickback	3 × 8–10 /side	1	90s
Hip Abduction Machine	3 × 12–15	0	60s

Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt

Back, shoulders and arms for a balanced, athletic shape.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
DB Chest Press	5 × 5	1–2	3 min
Lat Pulldown	5 × 5	1–2	3 min
Seated Cable Row	3 × 8–10	1	90s
DB Shoulder Press	3 × 8–10	1	90s
Lateral Raise	3 × 8–10	1	90s
Tricep Rope Pushdown	3 × 12–15	0	60s

Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring

Stretch-focused work for the glutes and hamstrings.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Smith Machine Squat	5 × 5	1–2	3 min
Lying Hamstring Curl	3 × 8–10	1	90s
Walking Lunges	3 × 8–10 /side	1	90s
45° Back Extension	3 × 8–10	1	90s
Frog Pumps	3 × 12–15	0	60s

Day 4 · Lower Body + Core

Heavy pulls, single-leg strength and core.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Sumo Deadlift	5 × 5	1–2	3 min
Step-Ups	3 × 8–10 /side	1	90s
Single-Leg Hip Thrust	3 × 8–10 /side	1	90s
Leg Press	3 × 8–10	1	90s
Weighted Plank	3 × 12–15	0	60s
Hanging Knee Raise	3 × 12–15	0	60s

Week 8

TEST PHASE

Reduced volume. Work up to a heavy 5 on main lifts, log PRs, then retake photos and measurements.

Day 1 · Glute Strength

Heavy hip extension: the foundation of glute size.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Barbell Hip Thrust	3 × Heavy 5	1	3 min
Romanian Deadlift	3 × Heavy 5	1	3 min
Bulgarian Split Squat	2 × 10–12 /side	2	75s
Cable Kickback	2 × 10–12 /side	2	75s
Hip Abduction Machine	2 × 15	1	60s

Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt

Back, shoulders and arms for a balanced, athletic shape.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
DB Chest Press	3 × Heavy 5	1	3 min
Lat Pulldown	3 × Heavy 5	1	3 min
Seated Cable Row	2 × 10–12	2	75s
DB Shoulder Press	2 × 10–12	2	75s
Lateral Raise	2 × 10–12	2	75s
Tricep Rope Pushdown	2 × 15	1	60s

Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring

Stretch-focused work for the glutes and hamstrings.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Smith Machine Squat	3 × Heavy 5	1	3 min
Lying Hamstring Curl	2 × 10–12	2	75s
Walking Lunges	2 × 10–12 /side	2	75s
45° Back Extension	2 × 10–12	2	75s
Frog Pumps	2 × 15	1	60s

Day 4 · Lower Body + Core

Heavy pulls, single-leg strength and core.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Sumo Deadlift	3 × Heavy 5	1	3 min
Step-Ups	2 × 10–12 /side	2	75s
Single-Leg Hip Thrust	2 × 10–12 /side	2	75s
Leg Press	2 × 10–12	2	75s
Weighted Plank	2 × 15	1	60s
Hanging Knee Raise	2 × 15	1	60s

PART III

Exercise Library

Setup, execution, cues, common mistakes and swaps for all 22 exercises in this program.

45° Back Extension

Glutes · Glute max, hamstrings · Equipment: 45° back extension bench

SETUP

1. Set the pad so it sits just below your hip bones, letting you hinge freely.
2. Turn your feet out slightly and hold a plate to your chest (optional).

EXECUTION

1. Round your upper back slightly and tuck your chin.
2. Lower your torso by hinging at the hips.
3. Squeeze your glutes to lift until your body is in a straight line — do not hyperextend.

CUES

- Pad below the hip bones
- Rounded upper back = more glutes
- Squeeze to rise

COMMON MISTAKES

- Pad too high, blocking the hinge
- Arching the lower back at the top
- Swinging up with momentum

EASIER / HARDER

Bodyweight only / Hold a plate or dumbbell, pause at the top

SWAPS

Romanian Deadlift, Reverse Hyperextension, Cable Pull-Through

Barbell Hip Thrust

Glutes · Glute max (primary), hamstrings, adductors · Equipment: Barbell, bench, bar pad

SETUP

1. Sit on the floor with the lower edge of your shoulder blades against a bench (bench height ~16 in / 40 cm is ideal).
2. Roll a padded barbell over your legs until it sits in the crease of your hips.
3. Feet flat, roughly hip-width, toes slightly out. At the top, your shins should be vertical.

EXECUTION

1. Brace your core and tuck your chin so your eyes look forward, not at the ceiling.
2. Drive through your heels and mid-foot to lift your hips until your torso is parallel to the floor.
3. Posteriorly tilt your pelvis at the top (think 'ribs down, tailbone under') and squeeze for 1 second.
4. Lower under control until your hips are just above the floor, then repeat without resting at the bottom.

CUES

- Ribs down, chin tucked
- Push the floor away through your heels
- Pivot around the bench — your upper back stays put

COMMON MISTAKES

- Arching the lower back at the top instead of squeezing the glutes
- Feet too close (more quads) or too far (more hamstrings)
- Looking at the ceiling, which pulls you into extension
- Rushing the top — no lockout, no squeeze

EASIER / HARDER

Glute Bridge or Machine Hip Thrust / Pause 3 sec at the top, or 1.5-rep thrusts

SWAPS

Smith Machine Hip Thrust, Machine Hip Thrust, Single-Leg Hip Thrust

Bulgarian Split Squat

Glutes · Glute max, quads, adductors · Equipment: Bench, dumbbells

SETUP

1. Stand about two feet in front of a bench and place the top of your back foot on it.
2. Hold dumbbells at your sides. Your front foot should be far enough forward that your front heel stays down at the bottom.

EXECUTION

1. Lean your torso forward slightly (about 20–30°) to bias the glutes.
2. Lower straight down until your back knee is just above the floor.
3. Drive through your whole front foot, emphasizing the heel, to return to the top.
4. Complete all reps on one side before switching.

CUES

- Down, not forward
- Front foot does the work — back foot is just for balance
- Lean in for glutes, stay upright for quads

COMMON MISTAKES

- Front foot too close, causing the heel to lift
- Pushing off the back foot
- Collapsing the front knee inward
- Going too heavy too soon and losing balance

EASIER / HARDER

Reverse Lunge or Split Squat with back foot on floor / Deficit front foot, 3-sec lowering, or 1.5 reps

SWAPS

Reverse Lunge, Step-Ups, Smith Machine Split Squat

Cable Kickback

Glutes · Glute max (upper fibers), glute med · Equipment: Cable machine, ankle strap

SETUP

1. Attach an ankle strap at the lowest pulley setting and secure it to your working ankle.
2. Face the machine, hold the frame, and hinge forward slightly with a soft standing knee.

EXECUTION

1. Keeping your torso still, kick the working leg back and slightly out (about 30° from center).
2. Stop when your glute is fully squeezed — before your lower back arches.
3. Hold for 1 second, then return slowly until the weight stack almost touches.

CUES

- Back and slightly out
- Hips square to the machine
- Squeeze, don't swing

COMMON MISTAKES

- Arching the back to get more range
- Using momentum
- Rotating the hips open
- Too much weight — this is a feel exercise

EASIER / HARDER

Banded Kickback or Dumbbell Kickback / 2-sec pause at peak contraction

SWAPS

Glute Kickback Machine, Dumbbell Kickback

DB Chest Press

Upper · Pecs, front delts, triceps · Equipment: Flat bench, dumbbells

SETUP

1. Sit on the end of the bench with the dumbbells standing on your thighs.
2. Lie back and use your knees to 'kick' the dumbbells up to your chest, one at a time if needed.
3. Pinch your shoulder blades together and down, plant your feet, and keep a slight natural arch.

EXECUTION

1. Press the dumbbells up and slightly together until your arms are straight (not locked hard).
2. Lower under control to chest level with elbows about 45° from your body.
3. At the bottom, the dumbbells should be roughly in line with your lower chest.
4. Press up again, keeping your shoulder blades pinned the whole time.

CUES

- Shoulder blades in your back pockets
- Elbows at 45°, not flared at 90°
- Push yourself away from the dumbbells

COMMON MISTAKES

- Flaring the elbows straight out
- Losing the shoulder-blade position at the top
- Bouncing at the bottom
- Dropping the dumbbells out to the sides after the set

EASIER / HARDER

Machine Chest Press or Push-Ups / Paused DB Bench Press or 3-sec lowering

SWAPS

Barbell Bench Press, Machine Chest Press, Smith Machine Press

DB Shoulder Press

Upper · Front & side delts, triceps, upper chest · Equipment: Adjustable bench, dumbbells

SETUP

1. Set the bench upright (about 80–90°).
2. Kick the dumbbells up to shoulder height, palms facing forward or slightly in.

EXECUTION

1. Press up and slightly in until your arms are nearly straight.
2. Lower until the dumbbells are about ear level.
3. Keep your ribs down and your back on the pad.

CUES

- Ribs down
- Press up and in
- Forearms vertical

COMMON MISTAKES

- Arching the back to turn it into an incline press
- Lowering too far and losing tension
- Clanking the dumbbells together

EASIER / HARDER

Machine Shoulder Press / Standing DB Press

SWAPS

Machine Shoulder Press, Arnold Press, Landmine Press

Frog Pumps

Glutes · Glute max · Equipment: Bodyweight or a dumbbell

SETUP

1. Lie on your back, put the soles of your feet together and let your knees fall out.
2. Bring your heels close to your glutes.

EXECUTION

1. Drive your hips up while squeezing your glutes hard.
2. Lower and repeat quickly with control — this is a high-rep pump finisher.

CUES

- Squeeze, don't arch
- Knees stay open

COMMON MISTAKES

- Pushing through the lower back
- Range too short

EASIER / HARDER

Glute Bridge / Hold a dumbbell on your hips

SWAPS

Glute Bridge, Banded Bridge

Hanging Knee Raise

Core · Lower abs, hip flexors · Equipment: Pull-up bar or captain's chair

SETUP

1. Hang from a bar with an overhand grip, or use a captain's chair.

EXECUTION

1. Curl your knees toward your chest by tucking your pelvis up.
2. Lower slowly without swinging.

CUES

- Curl, don't just lift
- No swinging

COMMON MISTAKES

- Swinging for momentum
- Only lifting the knees to 90° without pelvic tuck

EASIER / HARDER

Lying Reverse Crunch / Straight-leg raise

SWAPS

Reverse Crunch, Captain's Chair Raise

Hip Abduction Machine

Glutes · Glute med, glute min, upper glute max · Equipment: Hip abduction machine

SETUP

1. Set the start position so your legs begin together with tension on the pads.
2. For more glute focus, lean your torso forward over your thighs and hold the sides of the seat.

EXECUTION

1. Push your knees out against the pads as far as you can control.
2. Pause briefly, then return slowly — don't let the weights slam.
3. On the final set, finish with partial reps at the outer range until failure.

CUES

- Lead with your knees
- Slow on the way in
- Lean forward for upper glutes

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the stack bang between reps
- Using momentum from the torso
- Cutting the range short on every rep

EASIER / HARDER

Lighter weight with full range / Lean-forward version + 10 partials at the end

SWAPS

Banded Seated Abduction, Cable Hip Abduction, Side-Lying Hip Raise

Lat Pulldown

Upper · Lats, mid-back, biceps · Equipment: Lat pulldown machine

SETUP

1. Adjust the thigh pad so your legs are locked in snugly.
2. Grab the bar slightly wider than shoulder-width with an overhand grip.

EXECUTION

1. Lean back about 10–15° and lift your chest.
2. Pull the bar to your upper chest by driving your elbows down toward your back pockets.
3. Squeeze your lats for a moment, then let the bar rise slowly until your arms are straight and your shoulders stretch up.

CUES

- Elbows to back pockets
- Chest up to meet the bar
- Full stretch at the top

COMMON MISTAKES

- Pulling with the arms and biceps only
- Swinging the torso back for momentum
- Pulling the bar behind the neck
- Cutting the stretch at the top

EASIER / HARDER

Band-Assisted Pull-Up or lighter weight / Pull-Ups or 3-sec lowering

SWAPS

Assisted Pull-Up, Single-Arm Cable Pulldown, Pull-Ups

Lateral Raise

Upper · Side delts · Equipment: Dumbbells or cable

SETUP

1. Stand tall holding light dumbbells at your sides with a slight bend in your elbows.
2. Lean very slightly forward.

EXECUTION

1. Raise the dumbbells out to the sides, leading with your elbows.
2. Stop at shoulder height.
3. Lower slowly over 2–3 seconds.

CUES

- Lead with the elbows
- Reach out, not up
- Shoulders away from ears

COMMON MISTAKES

- Shrugging with the traps
- Swinging heavy weight
- Raising far above shoulder height

EASIER / HARDER

Seated Lateral Raise / Cable Lateral Raise or lean-away raise

SWAPS

Cable Lateral Raise, Machine Lateral Raise

Leg Press

Legs · Quads, glutes, adductors · Equipment: Leg press machine

SETUP

1. Sit with your back and hips flat against the pad.
2. Place your feet high and wide on the platform for more glute and hamstring, or mid-platform for quads.

EXECUTION

1. Release the safety handles.
2. Lower the platform until your knees are deeply bent — stop before your hips roll off the seat.
3. Press through your heels without locking your knees hard at the top.

CUES

- Hips stay down
- Heels heavy
- Control the bottom

COMMON MISTAKES

- Lowering so deep the lower back rounds off the pad
- Locking out knees forcefully
- Tiny half reps with huge weight

EASIER / HARDER

Lighter load, shorter range / Single-leg press or pause at the bottom

SWAPS

Hack Squat, Goblet Squat

Lying Hamstring Curl

Legs · Hamstrings · Equipment: Lying leg curl machine

SETUP

1. Lie face down with the pad just above your heels and your knees just off the edge of the bench.
2. Hold the handles and press your hips into the pad.

EXECUTION

1. Curl your heels toward your glutes as far as possible.
2. Squeeze, then lower over 3 seconds to a full stretch.

CUES

- Hips glued down
- Slow on the way down

COMMON MISTAKES

- Hips lifting off the pad
- Jerking the weight up
- Short range of motion

EASIER / HARDER

Lighter weight, slower tempo / Single-leg curls

SWAPS

Seated Leg Curl, Stability-Ball Hamstring Curl, Nordic Curl (advanced)

Romanian Deadlift

Glutes · Hamstrings, glute max, spinal erectors · Equipment: Barbell or dumbbells

SETUP

1. Stand tall holding the bar or dumbbells in front of your thighs, feet hip-width.
2. Unlock your knees slightly — they stay at this bend for the whole set.
3. Pull your shoulders back and down and brace your core.

EXECUTION

1. Push your hips straight back like you're closing a car door with your glutes.
2. Let the weight slide down the front of your thighs, staying close to your legs.
3. Lower until you feel a strong hamstring stretch — usually mid-shin. Your back stays neutral.
4. Drive your hips forward to stand, squeezing your glutes at the top without leaning back.

CUES

- Hips back, not down
- Weight stays glued to your legs
- Proud chest, long spine

COMMON MISTAKES

- Squatting the weight down (bending the knees more)
- Rounding the lower back to reach the floor
- Letting the weight drift away from your body
- Hyperextending at the top

EASIER / HARDER

Dumbbell RDL with a shorter range, or Cable Pull-Through / Single-Leg RDL, Deficit RDL, 3-sec lowering

SWAPS

Dumbbell RDL, Good Morning, 45° Back Extension

Seated Cable Row

Upper · Mid-back (rhomboids, traps), lats, rear delts · Equipment: Cable row station, V-handle

SETUP

1. Sit with feet on the platform and knees slightly bent.
2. Grab the handle and sit tall with a neutral spine.

EXECUTION

1. Pull the handle to your belly button while driving your elbows back.
2. Squeeze your shoulder blades together at the end of each rep.
3. Return slowly, letting your shoulders reach forward slightly for a stretch without rounding your lower back.

CUES

- Sit tall
- Elbows back, chest proud
- Squeeze a pencil between your shoulder blades

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rocking the torso back and forth
- Shrugging the shoulders up
- Rounding the lower back

EASIER / HARDER

Machine Row / Pause 2 sec at the squeeze

SWAPS

Chest-Supported Row, Single-Arm DB Row, Machine Row

Single-Leg Hip Thrust

Glutes · Glute max, glute med · Equipment: Bench

SETUP

1. Same setup as the hip thrust, with one foot planted and the other leg lifted with the knee bent.

EXECUTION

1. Drive through the planted heel to lift your hips.
2. Keep your hips level — don't let one side drop.
3. Squeeze at the top for 1 second, lower with control.

CUES

- Level hips
- Heel drive

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rotating the pelvis
- Pushing through the toes

EASIER / HARDER

Single-Leg Glute Bridge on the floor / Add a dumbbell on the working hip

SWAPS

B-Stance Hip Thrust

Smith Machine Squat

Legs · Quads, glute max, adductors · Equipment: Smith machine

SETUP

1. Set the bar at upper-chest height and place it on your upper back.
2. Step your feet slightly in front of the bar, a little wider than hip-width, toes slightly out.
3. Rotate the bar to unhook it.

EXECUTION

1. Sit back and down, keeping your chest proud.
2. Descend until your thighs are at least parallel, or as deep as you can keep a neutral spine.
3. Drive up through your whole foot, squeezing your glutes at the top.

CUES

- Sit between your hips
- Knees track over toes
- Whole foot pressure

COMMON MISTAKES

- Feet directly under the bar (very quad-dominant and hard on knees)
- Half reps
- Knees caving in

EASIER / HARDER

Goblet Squat or Leg Press / Pause at the bottom for 2 sec

SWAPS

Barbell Back Squat, Hack Squat, Leg Press

Step-Ups

Legs · Glutes, quads · Equipment: Box or bench, dumbbells

SETUP

1. Use a box or bench about knee height.
2. Place your whole working foot on the box.

EXECUTION

1. Lean slightly forward and drive through your top heel to stand up on the box.
2. Don't push off with your bottom foot — keep it light.
3. Lower slowly back down with the same leg.

CUES

- Top leg does all the work
- Slow on the way down

COMMON MISTAKES

- Pushing off the bottom toes
- Box too low
- Knee caving in

EASIER / HARDER

Lower box, no weight / Higher box or heavier dumbbells

SWAPS

Bulgarian Split Squat, Reverse Lunge

Sumo Deadlift

Glutes · Glutes, adductors, quads, hamstrings · Equipment: Barbell, kettlebell or dumbbell

SETUP

1. Take a wide stance with toes turned out 30–45°.
2. Grip the bar (or one heavy dumbbell) inside your knees.
3. Drop your hips, lift your chest and pull the slack out of the bar.

EXECUTION

1. Push the floor apart with your feet as you stand up.
2. Keep the bar close to your body.
3. Finish by squeezing your glutes — don't lean back.
4. Hinge back down under control.

CUES

- Spread the floor
- Chest up, hips through
- Knees out over toes

COMMON MISTAKES

- Hips shooting up first
- Knees caving
- Rounding the back

EASIER / HARDER

Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift / Barbell Sumo Deadlift with a pause below the knee

SWAPS

Trap-Bar Deadlift, Kettlebell Sumo Deadlift

Tricep Rope Pushdown

Upper · Triceps · Equipment: Cable machine, rope

SETUP

1. Set the pulley high and attach the rope.
2. Stand tall with your elbows pinned to your sides.

EXECUTION

1. Push the rope down until your arms are straight.
2. Spread the rope ends apart at the bottom and squeeze.
3. Let your forearms rise slowly to just past 90°.

CUES

- Elbows glued to your sides
- Split the rope
- Only your forearms move

COMMON MISTAKES

- Elbows drifting forward
- Leaning over the rope and using bodyweight

EASIER / HARDER

Band Pushdown / Single-arm pushdown

SWAPS

Straight-Bar Pushdown, Overhead Tricep Extension

Walking Lunges

Legs · Glutes, quads, adductors · Equipment: Dumbbells (optional)

SETUP

1. Hold dumbbells at your sides and find an open lane.

EXECUTION

1. Take a long step forward and lower until your back knee nearly touches the floor.
2. Push through your front heel and bring your back foot forward into the next step.
3. Keep your torso tall or slightly forward for more glute.

CUES

- Long stride for glutes
- Front shin roughly vertical
- Smooth and controlled

COMMON MISTAKES

- Short choppy steps
- Front knee caving in
- Slamming the back knee down

EASIER / HARDER

Stationary Reverse Lunge / Deficit lunges or heavier load

SWAPS

Reverse Lunge, Bulgarian Split Squat

Weighted Plank

Core · Abs, obliques, deep core · Equipment: Mat, plate (optional)

SETUP

1. Forearms on the floor, elbows under shoulders, legs straight.

EXECUTION

1. Squeeze your glutes and quads, pull your belly button in and push the floor away.
2. Hold a straight line from head to heels.
3. Add a plate on your upper back once 60 seconds is easy.

CUES

- Glutes tight
- Ribs pulled down

COMMON MISTAKES

- Hips sagging
- Hips piked high
- Holding your breath

EASIER / HARDER

Plank on knees / Add load or long-lever plank

SWAPS

Dead Bug, Ab Wheel

Day 1 · Glute Strength

WEEK 1 · LOG

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Foundation phase · Heavy hip extension: the foundation of glute size.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
Barbell Hip Thrust 3 × 10–12 · RIR 3 · 2 min				☐
Romanian Deadlift 3 × 10–12 · RIR 3 · 2 min				☐
Bulgarian Split Squat 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 3 · 75s				☐
Cable Kickback 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 3 · 75s				☐
Hip Abduction Machine 2 × 15–20 · RIR 2 · 60s				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt

WEEK 1 · LOG

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Foundation phase · Back, shoulders and arms for a balanced, athletic shape.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
DB Chest Press 3 × 10–12 · RIR 3 · 2 min				☐
Lat Pulldown 3 × 10–12 · RIR 3 · 2 min				☐
Seated Cable Row 3 × 12–15 · RIR 3 · 75s				☐
DB Shoulder Press 3 × 12–15 · RIR 3 · 75s				☐
Lateral Raise 3 × 12–15 · RIR 3 · 75s				☐
Tricep Rope Pushdown 2 × 15–20 · RIR 2 · 60s				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring

WEEK 1 · LOG

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Foundation phase · Stretch-focused work for the glutes and hamstrings.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
Smith Machine Squat 3 × 10–12 · RIR 3 · 2 min				☐
Lying Hamstring Curl 3 × 12–15 · RIR 3 · 75s				☐
Walking Lunges 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 3 · 75s				☐
45° Back Extension 3 × 12–15 · RIR 3 · 75s				☐
Frog Pumps 2 × 15–20 · RIR 2 · 60s				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 4 · Lower Body + Core

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Foundation phase · Heavy pulls, single-leg strength and core.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
Sumo Deadlift 3 × 10–12 · RIR 3 · 2 min				☐
Step-Ups 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 3 · 75s				☐
Single-Leg Hip Thrust 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 3 · 75s				☐
Leg Press 3 × 12–15 · RIR 3 · 75s				☐
Weighted Plank 2 × 15–20 · RIR 2 · 60s				☐
Hanging Knee Raise 2 × 15–20 · RIR 2 · 60s				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 1 · Glute Strength

WEEK 2 · LOG

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Foundation phase · Heavy hip extension: the foundation of glute size.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
Barbell Hip Thrust 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 2 min				☐
Romanian Deadlift 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 2 min				☐
Bulgarian Split Squat 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Cable Kickback 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Hip Abduction Machine 2 × 15–20 · RIR 1 · 60s				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt

WEEK 2 · LOG

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Foundation phase · Back, shoulders and arms for a balanced, athletic shape.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
DB Chest Press 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 2 min				☐
Lat Pulldown 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 2 min				☐
Seated Cable Row 3 × 12–15 · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
DB Shoulder Press 3 × 12–15 · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Lateral Raise 3 × 12–15 · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Tricep Rope Pushdown 2 × 15–20 · RIR 1 · 60s				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring

WEEK 2 · LOG

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Foundation phase · Stretch-focused work for the glutes and hamstrings.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
Smith Machine Squat 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 2 min				☐
Lying Hamstring Curl 3 × 12–15 · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Walking Lunges 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
45° Back Extension 3 × 12–15 · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Frog Pumps 2 × 15–20 · RIR 1 · 60s				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 4 · Lower Body + Core

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Foundation phase · Heavy pulls, single-leg strength and core.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
Sumo Deadlift 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 2 min				☐
Step-Ups 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Single-Leg Hip Thrust 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Leg Press 3 × 12–15 · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Weighted Plank 2 × 15–20 · RIR 1 · 60s				☐
Hanging Knee Raise 2 × 15–20 · RIR 1 · 60s				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets	New PR?

Day 1 · Glute Strength

WEEK 3 · LOG

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Build phase · Heavy hip extension: the foundation of glute size.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	✓
Barbell Hip Thrust 4 × 8–10 · RIR 2 · 2 min					☐
Romanian Deadlift 4 × 8–10 · RIR 2 · 2 min					☐
Bulgarian Split Squat 3 × 10–12 /side · RIR 2 · 75s					☐
Cable Kickback 3 × 10–12 /side · RIR 2 · 75s					☐
Hip Abduction Machine 3 × 15–20 · RIR 1 · 60s					☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt

Date _____ Bodyweight _____ Energy (1–10) _____ Sleep (hrs) _____

Build phase · Back, shoulders and arms for a balanced, athletic shape.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	✓
DB Chest Press 4 × 8–10 · RIR 2 · 2 min					☐
Lat Pulldown 4 × 8–10 · RIR 2 · 2 min					☐
Seated Cable Row 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 75s					☐
DB Shoulder Press 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 75s					☐
Lateral Raise 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 75s					☐
Tricep Rope Pushdown 3 × 15–20 · RIR 1 · 60s					☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐ Total sets _____ New PR? _____

Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring

Date _____ Bodyweight _____ Energy (1–10) _____ Sleep (hrs) _____

Build phase · Stretch-focused work for the glutes and hamstrings.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	✓
Smith Machine Squat 4 × 8–10 · RIR 2 · 2 min					☐
Lying Hamstring Curl 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 75s					☐
Walking Lunges 3 × 10–12 /side · RIR 2 · 75s					☐
45° Back Extension 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 75s					☐
Frog Pumps 3 × 15–20 · RIR 1 · 60s					☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐ Total sets _____ New PR? _____

Day 4 · Lower Body + Core

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Build phase · Heavy pulls, single-leg strength and core.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	✓
Sumo Deadlift 4 × 8–10 · RIR 2 · 2 min					☐
Step-Ups 3 × 10–12 /side · RIR 2 · 75s					☐
Single-Leg Hip Thrust 3 × 10–12 /side · RIR 2 · 75s					☐
Leg Press 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 75s					☐
Weighted Plank 3 × 15–20 · RIR 1 · 60s					☐
Hanging Knee Raise 3 × 15–20 · RIR 1 · 60s					☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 1 · Glute Strength

WEEK 4 · LOG

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Build phase · Heavy hip extension: the foundation of glute size.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	✓
Barbell Hip Thrust 4 × 8–10 · RIR 1–2 · 2 min					☐
Romanian Deadlift 4 × 8–10 · RIR 1–2 · 2 min					☐
Bulgarian Split Squat 3 × 10–12 /side · RIR 1–2 · 75s					☐
Cable Kickback 3 × 10–12 /side · RIR 1–2 · 75s					☐
Hip Abduction Machine 3 × 15–20 · RIR 0–1 · 60s					☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt

Date _____ Bodyweight _____ Energy (1–10) _____ Sleep (hrs) _____

Build phase · Back, shoulders and arms for a balanced, athletic shape.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	✓
DB Chest Press 4 × 8–10 · RIR 1–2 · 2 min					☐
Lat Pulldown 4 × 8–10 · RIR 1–2 · 2 min					☐
Seated Cable Row 3 × 10–12 · RIR 1–2 · 75s					☐
DB Shoulder Press 3 × 10–12 · RIR 1–2 · 75s					☐
Lateral Raise 3 × 10–12 · RIR 1–2 · 75s					☐
Tricep Rope Pushdown 3 × 15–20 · RIR 0–1 · 60s					☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐ Total sets _____ New PR? _____

Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring

Date _____ Bodyweight _____ Energy (1–10) _____ Sleep (hrs) _____

Build phase · Stretch-focused work for the glutes and hamstrings.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	✓
Smith Machine Squat 4 × 8–10 · RIR 1–2 · 2 min					☐
Lying Hamstring Curl 3 × 10–12 · RIR 1–2 · 75s					☐
Walking Lunges 3 × 10–12 /side · RIR 1–2 · 75s					☐
45° Back Extension 3 × 10–12 · RIR 1–2 · 75s					☐
Frog Pumps 3 × 15–20 · RIR 0–1 · 60s					☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐ Total sets _____ New PR? _____

Day 4 · Lower Body + Core

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Build phase · Heavy pulls, single-leg strength and core.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	✓
Sumo Deadlift 4 × 8–10 · RIR 1–2 · 2 min					☐
Step-Ups 3 × 10–12 /side · RIR 1–2 · 75s					☐
Single-Leg Hip Thrust 3 × 10–12 /side · RIR 1–2 · 75s					☐
Leg Press 3 × 10–12 · RIR 1–2 · 75s					☐
Weighted Plank 3 × 15–20 · RIR 0–1 · 60s					☐
Hanging Knee Raise 3 × 15–20 · RIR 0–1 · 60s					☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets _____

New PR? _____

Day 1 · Glute Strength

WEEK 5 · LOG

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Strength phase · Heavy hip extension: the foundation of glute size.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	✓
Barbell Hip Thrust 4 × 6–8 · RIR 2 · 2.5 min					☐
Romanian Deadlift 4 × 6–8 · RIR 2 · 2.5 min					☐
Bulgarian Split Squat 3 × 8–12 /side · RIR 2 · 90s					☐
Cable Kickback 3 × 8–12 /side · RIR 2 · 90s					☐
Hip Abduction Machine 3 × 12–15 · RIR 1 · 60s					☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt

Date _____ Bodyweight _____ Energy (1–10) _____ Sleep (hrs) _____

Strength phase · Back, shoulders and arms for a balanced, athletic shape.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	✓
DB Chest Press 4 × 6–8 · RIR 2 · 2.5 min					☐
Lat Pulldown 4 × 6–8 · RIR 2 · 2.5 min					☐
Seated Cable Row 3 × 8–12 · RIR 2 · 90s					☐
DB Shoulder Press 3 × 8–12 · RIR 2 · 90s					☐
Lateral Raise 3 × 8–12 · RIR 2 · 90s					☐
Tricep Rope Pushdown 3 × 12–15 · RIR 1 · 60s					☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐ Total sets _____ New PR? _____

Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring

Date _____ Bodyweight _____ Energy (1–10) _____ Sleep (hrs) _____

Strength phase · Stretch-focused work for the glutes and hamstrings.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	✓
Smith Machine Squat 4 × 6–8 · RIR 2 · 2.5 min					☐
Lying Hamstring Curl 3 × 8–12 · RIR 2 · 90s					☐
Walking Lunges 3 × 8–12 /side · RIR 2 · 90s					☐
45° Back Extension 3 × 8–12 · RIR 2 · 90s					☐
Frog Pumps 3 × 12–15 · RIR 1 · 60s					☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐ Total sets _____ New PR? _____

Day 4 · Lower Body + Core

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Strength phase · Heavy pulls, single-leg strength and core.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	✓
Sumo Deadlift 4 × 6–8 · RIR 2 · 2.5 min					☐
Step-Ups 3 × 8–12 /side · RIR 2 · 90s					☐
Single-Leg Hip Thrust 3 × 8–12 /side · RIR 2 · 90s					☐
Leg Press 3 × 8–12 · RIR 2 · 90s					☐
Weighted Plank 3 × 12–15 · RIR 1 · 60s					☐
Hanging Knee Raise 3 × 12–15 · RIR 1 · 60s					☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets _____

New PR? _____

Day 1 · Glute Strength

WEEK 6 · LOG

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Strength phase · Heavy hip extension: the foundation of glute size.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	✓
Barbell Hip Thrust 4 × 6–8 · RIR 1–2 · 2.5 min					☐
Romanian Deadlift 4 × 6–8 · RIR 1–2 · 2.5 min					☐
Bulgarian Split Squat 3 × 8–12 /side · RIR 1–2 · 90s					☐
Cable Kickback 3 × 8–12 /side · RIR 1–2 · 90s					☐
Hip Abduction Machine 3 × 12–15 · RIR 0–1 · 60s					☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt

Date _____ Bodyweight _____ Energy (1–10) _____ Sleep (hrs) _____

Strength phase · Back, shoulders and arms for a balanced, athletic shape.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	✓
DB Chest Press 4 × 6–8 · RIR 1–2 · 2.5 min					☐
Lat Pulldown 4 × 6–8 · RIR 1–2 · 2.5 min					☐
Seated Cable Row 3 × 8–12 · RIR 1–2 · 90s					☐
DB Shoulder Press 3 × 8–12 · RIR 1–2 · 90s					☐
Lateral Raise 3 × 8–12 · RIR 1–2 · 90s					☐
Tricep Rope Pushdown 3 × 12–15 · RIR 0–1 · 60s					☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐ Total sets _____ New PR? _____

Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring

Date | Bodyweight | Energy (1–10) | Sleep (hrs)

Strength phase · Stretch-focused work for the glutes and hamstrings.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	✓
Smith Machine Squat 4 × 6–8 · RIR 1–2 · 2.5 min					☐
Lying Hamstring Curl 3 × 8–12 · RIR 1–2 · 90s					☐
Walking Lunges 3 × 8–12 /side · RIR 1–2 · 90s					☐
45° Back Extension 3 × 8–12 · RIR 1–2 · 90s					☐
Frog Pumps 3 × 12–15 · RIR 0–1 · 60s					☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 4 · Lower Body + Core

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Strength phase · Heavy pulls, single-leg strength and core.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	✓
Sumo Deadlift 4 × 6–8 · RIR 1–2 · 2.5 min					☐
Step-Ups 3 × 8–12 /side · RIR 1–2 · 90s					☐
Single-Leg Hip Thrust 3 × 8–12 /side · RIR 1–2 · 90s					☐
Leg Press 3 × 8–12 · RIR 1–2 · 90s					☐
Weighted Plank 3 × 12–15 · RIR 0–1 · 60s					☐
Hanging Knee Raise 3 × 12–15 · RIR 0–1 · 60s					☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets _____

New PR? _____

Day 1 · Glute Strength

Date _____ Bodyweight _____ Energy (1–10) _____ Sleep (hrs) _____

Peak phase · Heavy hip extension: the foundation of glute size.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	SET 5 LB × REPS	✓
Barbell Hip Thrust 5 × 5 · RIR 1–2 · 3 min						☐
Romanian Deadlift 5 × 5 · RIR 1–2 · 3 min						☐
Bulgarian Split Squat 3 × 8–10 /side · RIR 1 · 90s						☐
Cable Kickback 3 × 8–10 /side · RIR 1 · 90s						☐
Hip Abduction Machine 3 × 12–15 · RIR 0 · 60s						☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐ Total sets _____ New PR? _____

Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt

WEEK 7 · LOG

Date | Bodyweight | Energy (1–10) | Sleep (hrs)

Peak phase · Back, shoulders and arms for a balanced, athletic shape.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	SET 5 LB × REPS	✓
DB Chest Press 5 × 5 · RIR 1–2 · 3 min						☐
Lat Pulldown 5 × 5 · RIR 1–2 · 3 min						☐
Seated Cable Row 3 × 8–10 · RIR 1 · 90s						☐
DB Shoulder Press 3 × 8–10 · RIR 1 · 90s						☐
Lateral Raise 3 × 8–10 · RIR 1 · 90s						☐
Tricep Rope Pushdown 3 × 12–15 · RIR 0 · 60s						☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐ | Total sets | New PR?

Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Peak phase · Stretch-focused work for the glutes and hamstrings.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	SET 5 LB × REPS	✓
Smith Machine Squat 5 × 5 · RIR 1–2 · 3 min						☐
Lying Hamstring Curl 3 × 8–10 · RIR 1 · 90s						☐
Walking Lunges 3 × 8–10 /side · RIR 1 · 90s						☐
45° Back Extension 3 × 8–10 · RIR 1 · 90s						☐
Frog Pumps 3 × 12–15 · RIR 0 · 60s						☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 4 · Lower Body + Core

Date _____ Bodyweight _____ Energy (1–10) _____ Sleep (hrs) _____

Peak phase · Heavy pulls, single-leg strength and core.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	SET 4 LB × REPS	SET 5 LB × REPS	✓
Sumo Deadlift 5 × 5 · RIR 1–2 · 3 min						☐
Step-Ups 3 × 8–10 /side · RIR 1 · 90s						☐
Single-Leg Hip Thrust 3 × 8–10 /side · RIR 1 · 90s						☐
Leg Press 3 × 8–10 · RIR 1 · 90s						☐
Weighted Plank 3 × 12–15 · RIR 0 · 60s						☐
Hanging Knee Raise 3 × 12–15 · RIR 0 · 60s						☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐ Total sets _____ New PR? _____

Day 1 · Glute Strength

WEEK 8 · LOG

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Test phase · Heavy hip extension: the foundation of glute size.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
Barbell Hip Thrust 3 × Heavy 5 · RIR 1 · 3 min				☐
Romanian Deadlift 3 × Heavy 5 · RIR 1 · 3 min				☐
Bulgarian Split Squat 2 × 10–12 /side · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Cable Kickback 2 × 10–12 /side · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Hip Abduction Machine 2 × 15 · RIR 1 · 60s				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 2 · Upper Body Sculpt

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Test phase · Back, shoulders and arms for a balanced, athletic shape.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
DB Chest Press 3 × Heavy 5 · RIR 1 · 3 min				☐
Lat Pulldown 3 × Heavy 5 · RIR 1 · 3 min				☐
Seated Cable Row 2 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
DB Shoulder Press 2 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Lateral Raise 2 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Tricep Rope Pushdown 2 × 15 · RIR 1 · 60s				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets	New PR?

Day 3 · Glute & Hamstring

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Test phase · Stretch-focused work for the glutes and hamstrings.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
Smith Machine Squat 3 × Heavy 5 · RIR 1 · 3 min				☐
Lying Hamstring Curl 2 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Walking Lunges 2 × 10–12 /side · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
45° Back Extension 2 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Frog Pumps 2 × 15 · RIR 1 · 60s				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 4 · Lower Body + Core

Date _____ Bodyweight _____ Energy (1–10) _____ Sleep (hrs) _____

Test phase · Heavy pulls, single-leg strength and core.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
Sumo Deadlift 3 × Heavy 5 · RIR 1 · 3 min				☐
Step-Ups 2 × 10–12 /side · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Single-Leg Hip Thrust 2 × 10–12 /side · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Leg Press 2 × 10–12 · RIR 2 · 75s				☐
Weighted Plank 2 × 15 · RIR 1 · 60s				☐
Hanging Knee Raise 2 × 15 · RIR 1 · 60s				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐ Total sets _____ New PR? _____

Measurements & Check-Ins

EVERY 2 WEEKS

Measure in the morning, before eating, at the same spots each time. Photos: front, side and back, same lighting.

DATE	WEIGHT	WAIST	HIPS	GLUTES	THIGH	ARM	NOTES

REFLECTIONS

PR Log

Estimated 1RM = weight × (1 + reps ÷ 30).

LIFT	DATE	WEIGHT	REPS	EST. 1RM	NOTES